returning with a little money and some chintz or silks to make clothes for his wife and children with whom he hopes to pass the winter months happily, and when within a few miles of home, some Koordish horseman, who like Catharine's man at arms has done nothing all the year round but swagger about with his sword and lance [, robs him]; this man I would hang on the highest tree I could find, and perhaps with as little pity as I would kill a wild duck.

P: S: *7th* July. I add this post script to salute my dear Father and you upon my birthday. I dine at M' d'Ozeroffs to night it being the birth day of the Emperor, so I hope to drink your healths in iced champaigne. The courier arrived from Tehran yesterday but we have nothing in the way of news, except the marriage of the Heir Apparent,[95] at which they had seven days feasting etc. at which the Shah entertained a whole camp of poor people, Mahomedans, Armenians and Jews who encamped close to his palace outside the town.

*Tabreez, August 6, 1845*

We had a smart shock of an earthquake on the 9th July or rather two, one early in the morning. I had been up about an hour and was smoking my first pipe after coffee, it might have been at about six o'clock. This was very slight. The other was about twelve, mid-day; the meerza (secretary) and I were busy making up our monthly newspaper; it was a strong trembling motion but not so violent as I have formerly felt, and of much longer duration. The Meerza said, "wī wī zilzilla" (clap clap an earthquake) and we both rose and went to the window. But did not run out. We stood some time and when I sat down the ground was still trembling; these earthquakes were felt exactly at the same time at Merrend a town forty miles north and Ouroumia a town 80 miles west of this and I believe in the surrounding districts. At Merrend the mid-day one was rather violent and threw down some walls and houses, I believe one man was killed and several hurt. I have almost made a resolution never to run out of a house for an earthquake. Most people when an earthquake occurs jump out of windows or run out of doors to get out of the way of the falling walls. And I have seen so many accidents in the falling of people one over another, and crowds rushing together etc. that I have almost determined never to run.

I believe my affairs will shortly call me to Tehran. For I have been endeavouring for the last two years, without success to come to some arrangement with my creditors and to do so I am now obliged to go to Tehran. I have not troubled you with these matters because it is by no means a pleasant subject to dwell upon and until something definite is arranged there is no use in it. I believe I shall

[95] This would be Nasir i Din, then fifteen years of age.

Generated on 2020-09-16 00:17 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112393
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN